Weekly Bulletin of IT News and Articles

(19 January 2026 – 26 January 2026)

Department of Strategy and Analysis
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CALENDAR OF UPCOMING EVENTS					
Date&Days	**Event name**	**Description**	**Location**	**Venue holder**	**Official Website**
Monday *(Jan 26)*	NANOG 94	Networking & network engineering conference covering automation, cloud, IPv6 & security.	*USA*	NANOG	https://nanog.org/
	ARISA AI Skills Workshop	EU workshop on future AI skills and cooperation	Brussels / Online	ARISA Project	https://euagenda.eu/
	Cohere Labs Online AI Talk	Research series on cognitive AI.	Online	Cohere Labs	https://cohere.com/events?utm_source
Tuesday *(Jan 27)*	Trends in Functional Programming	Tech conference on modern software techniques.	Odense, Denmark	Dev.events	https://dev.events/?utm_source
	NHIcon: Agentic AI Security	Online conference focused on AI security topics.	Online	Dev.events	https://dev.events/?utm_source
	Cohere Labs – Vision AI Talk	Online webinar on computer vision research.	Online	Cohere Labs	https://cohere.com/events?utm_source
Wednesday *(Jan 28)*	Open Lakehouse & AI	Conference on data platforms & AI integration.	Berlin & Amsterdam	Dev.events	https://dev.events/?utm_source

	NANOG 94 *(Day 3)*	Final day of network systems event.	TBD	NANOG	https://nanog.org/
	AI + Data Predictions Virtual	Online tech event on AI & data trends.	Online	Dev.events	https://dev.events/?utm_source
Thursday *(Jan 29)*	Product-Led Summit	Conference for SaaS product leadership & strategy.	Washington, DC	Dev.events	https://dev.events/?utm_source
	Agile Austria Conference 2026	Tech & agile software development conference.	Graz, Austria	Dev.events	https://dev.events/?utm_source
	betterCode GenAI 2026	Online event focused on generative AI coding practices	Online	Dev.events	https://cloudtechtallinn.com/?utm_source
Friday *(Jan 30)*	**Drupal EU Government Day**	Open-source web tech for public sector	Brussels, Belgium	Dev.events	https://dev.events/?utm_source
	EU Open Source Policy Summit	Open-source policy & governance event.	Brussels	EU Policy Group	https://euagenda.eu/
	AI + Data Predictions *(Cont.)*	Continued online tech talks.	Online	Dev.events	https://dev.events/?utm_source
Saturday *(Jan 31)*	Cloud Tech Tallinn 2026	Cloud & infrastructure tech event.	Tallinn, Estonia	Dev.events	https://dev.events/?utm_source
	AWSome Women	Online community conference on AWS & cloud topics	Online	Dev.events	https://fosdem.org/?utm_source
	FOSDEM 2026	Major free open-source developer conference.	Brussels, Belgium	FOSDEM Team	https://fosdem.org/?utm_source

CIS NEWS

1. Kazakhstan has officially enacted a new law on artificial intelligence

(The Caspian Post)

On January 18, 2026, the **Republic of Kazakhstan** officially implemented a comprehensive legal framework for the regulation of artificial intelligence, marking a significant milestone in Central Asian digital governance. As reported by *The Caspian Post* and citing the **Ministry of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Development**, this new legislation – Law No. 230-VIII "On Artificial Intelligence"– establishes clear rules for the development, safety, and ethical use of AI technologies within the country.

The core of the legislation is a risk-based classification system that categorizes AI technologies according to their potential threat to human rights and public safety. The law explicitly prohibits "unacceptable risk" applications, which include social scoring systems, manipulative techniques designed to influence the human subconscious, and the non-consensual use of emotion recognition technology. High-risk systems, particularly those used in critical infrastructure or government services, face stringent compliance requirements, including mandatory audits and inclusion in state registries to ensure they meet rigorous security standards.

To combat misinformation and protect user rights, the law enforces **strict transparency protocols.** Any content generated or significantly modified by AI – whether text, audio, or video – must be clearly labeled as "synthetic content" to ensure users are aware they are interacting with non-human systems. In the domain of intellectual property, the legislation clarifies that works created entirely by artificial intelligence without human input are not eligible for copyright protection. However, **the law does recognize the creative effort involved in prompting**; human-written prompts can be copyrighted if they demonstrate sufficient creative contribution. Additionally, content creators have been granted the right to "opt-out" of having their work used for AI model training.

Beyond regulation, the law aims to stimulate domestic innovation through the creation of a National Artificial Intelligence Platform. This state-run infrastructure is designed to aggregate data libraries and provide essential computing power to local startups and developers, reducing barriers to entry in the global AI market. The implementation of this strategy is led by the **Ministry of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Development**, a specialized body mandated to integrate AI across economic sectors while safeguarding Kazakhstan's data sovereignty and national security.

(Read full article at https://caspianpost.com/kazakhstan/kazakhstan-adopts-its-first-ai-law)

2. Digital transformation of Kyrgyzstan's fishing sector

(The Times of Central Asia)

The **Ministry of Agriculture** is actively overhauling Kyrgyzstan's fishing industry with a focus on transparency and digitalization. The **Department of Fisheries** has introduced a comprehensive suite of **electronic services designed to support both commercial aquaculture and recreational activities.**

For entrepreneurs, a unified digital registry now catalogs fishery water bodies and entities. This automated system **allows businesses to access state services electronically, streamlining operations and reducing the reliance on informal, paper-based transactions**.

For the public, a new electronic fishing permit system has been launched. Anglers can purchase permits directly through the official ministry website, with payments processed via **QR** codes. To ensure smooth adoption, the ministry has also distributed step-by-step video tutorials on social media.

A critical focus of the transformation is the implementation of a fish traceability system. This initiative aims to verify compliance with veterinary and sanitary standards, thereby boosting the export potential of products labeled "Made in Kyrgyzstan." These efforts support a growing industry that produced approximately 19,500 tons of fish by the end of 2025, with the Chui region contributing the majority at 12,800 tons.

(Read full article at https://timesca.com/kyrgyzstans-fishing-industry-goes-digital/#:~:text=The%20Ministry%20of%20Agriculture%20has,and%20a%20fish%20traceability%20system.)

3. Turkmenistan secures CIS backing ahead of 2026 chairmanship

(The Times of Central Asia)

The Commonwealth of Independent States *(CIS)* has pledged full support for Turkmenistan's chairmanship in 2026, with member states agreeing to provide comprehensive organizational and analytical assistance. Despite its traditional policy of permanent neutrality, Ashgabat aims to use this leadership role to prioritize economic cooperation, transport connectivity, and humanitarian initiatives.

This chairmanship represents a strategic opportunity for Turkmenistan to shape the bloc's agenda through a pragmatic approach, balancing its neutral stance with the need for practical regional integration. As Central Asian nations navigate shifting geopolitical

dynamics, Ashgabat is expected to focus on trade and migration frameworks, with final agenda details to be announced in the coming months.

Turkmenistan's 2026 CIS chairmanship represents a calculated diplomatic maneuver to advance its national interests without compromising its core doctrine of permanent neutrality. By securing unanimous support to lead the bloc, Ashgabat is positioning itself to steer regional cooperation toward pragmatic economic and transport connectivity – sectors vital for its landlocked economy. Ultimately, this move allows Turkmenistan to selectively engage with post-Soviet institutions to bolster trade and logistics, ensuring it remains a relevant player in Central Asia's shifting geopolitical landscape while avoiding entangling political alliances.

(Read full article at https://timesca.com/turkmenistan-secures-cis-backing-ahead-of-2026-chairmanship/#:~:text=January%2023%2C%202026,within%20the%20post%2DSoviet%20bloc.)

4. Kazakhstan's domestic drone production initiative

(The Times of Central Asia)

Kazakhstan's Airborne Assault Forces *(AAF)* have successfully **established an independent production base for unmanned aerial systems** *(UAS)*, marking a strategic shift toward military self-reliance. Since the specialized facility began operations in December 2025, approximately **100 drones have been assembled and deployed**, significantly reducing dependence on foreign suppliers.

These domestic units were validated during the "Desant-2025" exercises and will be supported by a new systematic operator training program launching in 2026. This military advancement aligns with broader national trends, including upcoming civilian drone initiatives for delivery services in Almaty and agricultural monitoring in East **Kazakhstan**.

Kazakhstan's establishment of indigenous drone production marks a decisive shift toward technological sovereignty and modern defense. By internalizing the entire manufacturing cycle, the Airborne Assault Forces are securing critical supply chains against geopolitical risks and accelerating the adoption of unmanned systems. This initiative enhances combat readiness through immediate deployment and specialized training while reinforcing a national drive for innovation that benefits both military and civilian sectors.

(Read full article at https://timesca.com/kazakh-military-advances-domestic-drone-production/)

5. Kazakhstan joins OpenAI's education for countries initiative

(*The Times of Central Asia*)

Kazakhstan has been selected as one of the inaugural partners in OpenAI's "Education for Countries" initiative, aiming to integrate artificial intelligence directly into its national education system. This move, stemming from agreements signed during **President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev's** November 2025 visit to the U.S., positions Kazakhstan alongside early adopters like Estonia and the UAE. The program focuses on rolling out ChatGPT Edu, a platform designed to assist rather than replace educators by streamlining administrative tasks and enabling personalized instruction.

The initiative is notably financed entirely through private funding from Freedom Holding Corp. and Bilim Group, requiring no state budget or international grants. Beginning in January 2026 – declared the "**Year of Artificial Intelligence and Digitalization**" – the program will distribute 165,000 free licenses: 100,000 for K-12 and vocational teachers, 62,800 for university faculty, and 2,200 for the Astana Hub tech ecosystem. Comprehensive training led by OpenAI specialists will accompany this rollout to ensure effective usage in Kazakh, Russian, and English.

This partnership reinforces Kazakhstan's status as the leader in AI adoption within Central Asia. As of late 2025, the country ranked 72nd globally with 13.7% of its workforce using AI tools – significantly ahead of neighbors like Kyrgyzstan *(8.2%)* and Uzbekistan *(6.3%)*. Government officials emphasize that this is a core infrastructure upgrade meant to train *"creators"* of AI, not just users, aligning with **President Tokayev's** view that AI capability is now a primary dividing line for future national competitiveness.

(Read full article at https://timesca.com/kazakhstan-joins-openais-education-for-countries-initiative/)

GLOBAL NEWS

6. Japan's AI Market Searchlight: Kioxia Emerges as a Critical Proxy

(Financial Times)

While Japan's high-tech reputation remains globally recognized, the domestic stock market lacks a direct peer to Nvidia or a platform-scale AI giant. This scarcity has redirected investor focus toward Kioxia, a chipmaker that has successfully pivoted from the volatile consumer electronics sector to the high-growth requirements of AI data centers.

Historically, Kioxia's core business involved NAND flash memory – a product long treated as a commodity for smartphones and other price-sensitive consumer devices. However, the landscape shifted as training large-scale AI models necessitated massive storage volumes within data center infrastructure. Following a 2024 price crash of nearly 50

percent, a period of under-investment coupled with this new demand has restored significant pricing power to chipmakers like Kioxia.

Kioxia's stock has reflected this transformation, achieving a remarkable 800 percent rally over the past 12 months. Despite this surge, market analysts note that the company still trades at a relatively conservative 12 times forward earnings. This valuation suggests that while Kioxia is a primary beneficiary of the AI trend, it remains exposed to the inherent cyclicality of the memory market and potential shifts in data center spending.

As the initial phase of AI infrastructure build-out matures, investor interest is expected to broaden. While Kioxia currently *"shines"* due to a lack of local alternatives, long-term capital is likely to seek out companies controlling "bottleneck" components that are harder to replicate. These include specialists in **advanced chipmaking gear**, **specialty chemicals and precision components** and **Advanced packaging technologies**

(Read full article at https://www.ft.com/content/13c5ac7d-c19d-48b5-9b91-2ce1caf57c67)

7. Trump's TikTok deal is a gift to China

(Financial Times)

The long-standing conflict between the US government and TikTok has reached a decisive resolution through a complex joint venture agreement. While the deal allows **President Trump** to avoid the political fallout of a total ban, it ultimately represents a major strategic triumph for TikTok's Chinese parent company, ByteDance. By navigating five years of intense regulatory scrutiny and national security concerns, ByteDance has successfully secured its future in one of its most influential markets while keeping its most valuable technological assets firmly under its control.

The agreement to keep TikTok operating in the US through a joint venture marks a significant win for ByteDance, as it resolves a years-long political battle while allowing the Chinese company to keep its most valuable technology. Rather than a total ban or a forced sale, the new arrangement functions like a franchise where governance is separated from the underlying technology. While a new US entity and Oracle will handle data security and content moderation, ByteDance retains ownership of the famous recommendation algorithm, merely licensing it to the US side. This setup is crucial because the Chinese government previously blocked the export of such algorithms, and ByteDance needed to keep its global platform unified to remain attractive to creators and advertisers.

This outcome is especially favorable for ByteDance as it enters a period of massive financial dominance and technological expansion. With 2024 revenues hitting $ 155 billion and profits reaching $ 33 billion, ByteDance has outpaced traditional giants like Alibaba and Tencent, even briefly surpassing Meta in sales. Now that the threat of a US ban is gone, the company is shifting its focus toward becoming a global leader in artificial intelligence. Backed by massive investments in computing power and $ 14 billion worth of Nvidia chips, ByteDance is positioning itself as a top-tier national champion for China, ready to compete on a global scale with its core technology fully intact.

(Read full article at https://www.ft.com/content/59b91fc8-03a1-48df-9821-e2fdff24bd33)

8. Trump-weary danes turn to technology in boycott of US brands technological resistance

(finance.yahoo)

In January 2026, a wave of "Trump-weary" sentiment swept through Denmark, driven by renewed geopolitical tensions regarding Greenland. Following President Donald Trump's intensified calls to acquire Greenland – and threats of tariffs against nations supporting its Danish ownership – Danish citizens have increasingly turned to digital tools to express their opposition. This diplomatic friction has triggered a consumer-led boycott of American goods, with technology playing a central role in enabling the protest.

To facilitate this boycott, Danish consumers are heavily utilizing mobile applications designed to identify the origin of products. Apps such as **NonUSA** *(also known as UdenUSA)* and **Made O'Meter** have surged to the top of the country's download charts. These applications allow users to scan product barcodes in real-time to determine if an item is American-made. If a US origin is detected, the apps suggest local or non-American alternatives, effectively empowering consumers to vote with their wallets against US policies.

The popularity of these tools has been explosive, with download numbers for the leading boycott apps soaring by over 800% in a single week. The impact is threatening major US brands with significant global footprints, such as **Coca-Cola**, **Netflix**, and **Procter & Gamble**, as users opt for local substitutes. While the movement originated in Denmark, reports indicate that the digital boycott is expanding across the Nordic region, with increased app activity observed in **Norway**, **Sweden**, and **Iceland**, suggesting a broader regional solidarity against the US administration's stance on the Arctic.

(Read full article at https://finance.yahoo.com/news/trump-weary-danes-turn-technology-133000567.html)

9. The year of the 'hectocorn': the $ 100 bn tech companies that could float in 2026

(www.theguardian.com)

Wall Street is currently reacting to reports from January 22 predicting that 2026 will be the defining year for "$ 100 billion Hectocorn" IPOs. OpenAI leads this potential wave, rumored to be seeking a valuation as high as $ 1 trillion while planning to spend an unprecedented $ 1.4 trillion on infrastructure over the next eight years.

Concurrently, SpaceX and Anthropic are reportedly preparing for public floats that could fundamentally reorder the S&P 500. The sheer scale of this spending and valuation has sparked intense debate among analysts, who are questioning whether the market is witnessing a "trillion-dollar bubble" or the beginning of a genuine industrial revolution.

The 2026 "Hectocorn" IPO wave, led by OpenAI's potential $ 1 trillion valuations, marks a definitive test for global markets. As giants like SpaceX and Anthropic prepare to reshape the S&P 500, investors must decide if these unprecedented capital demands signal a speculative bubble or the start of a genuine industrial revolution.

(Read full article at https://www.theguardian.com/business/2026/jan/22/the-year-of-the-hectocorn-the-100bn-tech-companies-that-could-float-in-2026)

10. Singapore to invest over $ 779 million in public AI research through 2030

(Reuters)

The Singaporean government has confirmed a capital injection of over S$ 1 billion *(approximately $ 779 million)* into public sector artificial intelligence research, effective through 2030. Announced on January 24, 2026, by the **Ministry of Digital Development and Information**, this funding is designed to cement the nation's technological sovereignty. It builds upon a massive 2024 financial commitment, which included S$ 500 million for high-performance computing infrastructure and an additional S$ 500 million for "AI Singapore," the national program driving domestic expertise. The new tranche of funding prioritizes "responsible AI" and "resource-efficient systems" – crucial for a small nation with limited energy resources – while aggressively expanding the talent pipeline from pre-university education to advanced faculty research.

The "Sea-Lion" ModelA cornerstone of this strategy is the "Sea-Lion" *(Southeast Asian Languages in One Network)* large language model, initially developed with S$ 70 million in funding to address the linguistic gap in Western-centric AI.

The latest iteration, released in October 2025, was built upon Alibaba's "Qwen" foundation model, significantly enhancing performance in regional languages such as Burmese, Filipino, Indonesian, Malay, Tamil, Thai, and Vietnamese.

The model has already been integrated by regional giants like Indonesia's GoTo group. In a major move toward decentralization, AI Singapore has recently collaborated with Dell Technologies *(January 2026)* to optimize Sea-Lion for "AI PCs" and edge devices. This partnership aims to allow the model to run locally on laptops without internet reliance, improving data privacy and reducing latency for users across Southeast Asia.

(Read full article at https://www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/singapore-invest-over-779-million-public-ai-research-through-2030-2026-01-24/)

11. Meta pauses teen access to AI characters

(apnews.com)

Meta Platforms Inc. is proactively halting teenager access to its AI-generated "characters" on Instagram and WhatsApp, citing the need to develop a safer user experience.

Scheduled for implementation in the coming weeks, this suspension targets both registered minors and users suspected to be underage by Meta's behavioral age-prediction technology. Crucially, the restriction is specific to conversational personas used for entertainment or roleplay; teens will retain full access to the standard Meta AI assistant for utility and information-based tasks.

The timing of this policy shift is critical, arriving just days before Meta, TikTok, and YouTube are set to face a major trial in Los Angeles regarding the impact of their platforms on child safety. The move also mirrors a growing industry trend toward restricting AI-minor interactions, following similar measures taken by Character.AI last fall. That platform banned teen access after facing lawsuits alleging that emotional dependency on AI chatbots contributed to severe psychological distress and self-harm among adolescents.

(Read full article at https://apnews.com/article/artificial-intelligence-meta-teens-ai-characters-access-f64d53df26893cfefa97dc1249d73ab6)

ANALYSIS

12. Opinion: Kazakhstan Bets Big on AI to Power Local and Global Growth

(The Times of Central Asia)

In his recent State of the Nation address, the **President** of **Kazakhstan** articulated a bold and ambitious future for the country. He presented a new vision, central to which was the announcement of artificial intelligence adoption and digitization as new national

priorities, positioning them as essential for the country's economic modernization and long-term competitiveness.

The speech marked a significant moment for the government. Historically, much of its policy focus has been on managing risk and navigating regulatory uncertainty. Now, the administration is pivoting to focus instead on high-growth, innovation-led initiatives to build a more competitive and resilient Kazakhstan that can thrive in a rapidly changing global economy.

Kazakhstan is embracing leapfrog innovation to harness tools such as AI and blockchain technologies to help accelerate economic growth and diversify its economy. This bet will ensure that the nation remains competitive for generations to come in a digital-led global landscape where technology leadership increasingly defines prosperity.

Central to the project's long-term success is the evolution of Kazakhstan's educational system, and the country has recently approved its first national framework for integrating AI into its curriculum, signaling a major shift toward future-ready learning.

(Read full article at https://timesca.com/kazakhstan-bets-big-on-ai-to-power-local-and-global-growth/)

13. Building Trust in Kazakhstan's Fast-Growing Fintech Ecosystem

(Astana Times)

Kazakhstan's leading fintech platforms Kaspi, Halyk Bank's Homebank, and Freedom SuperApp have evolved into all-in-one super-apps offering banking, payments, shopping, and even eGov services. They provide great convenience, but also concentrate vast amounts of personal data. This raises data privacy and security risks that deserves a clear look and a set of practical safeguards that keep users protected.

Kazakhstan has already faced several breaches and fraud cases. Freedom Finance admitted in 2020 that hackers stole tens of thousands of client records after a phishing attack, exposing full names, passport details, bank accounts and even employee credentials. Kaspi.kz has faced repeated public concern: a nationwide outage in 2020 triggered fears of a hack, and in 2025 dozens of customers reported loans issued in their names without consent, with investigations

pointing to stolen personal data and possible insider collusion. Halyk Bank has also faced public concern in 2020, from a rumored leak of 80,000 records to waves of complaints about unauthorized withdrawals. Together, these cases show how quickly problems can escalate when so much financial and personal data is concentrated in a few platforms, and how hard it can be for official reassurances to match the level of public concern.

Kazakhstan's digital finance sector has moved fast, and now trust will shape its next stage. By addressing data concentration risks early, the country can strengthen user confidence and avoid disruptions that could slow progress. The payoff is clear: continued growth built on a foundation of safety and transparency. In an age when data is as valuable as currency, combining innovation with strong protections will allow Kazakhstan to set a regional standard for secure, sustainable fintech development.

(Read full article at https://astanatimes.com/2026/01/building-trust-in-kazakhstans-fast-growing-fintech-ecosystem/)